

Email Security Basics

Email security protects your email from unauthorised access, fraud, and malicious content. Email is the top target for cyber attacks like phishing and malware because everyone uses it daily for personal and work communication.

Attackers pretend to be banks, colleagues, or trusted contacts to trick you into clicking links, opening attachments, or sharing information.

Common email risks

Watch out for these threats:

- Phishing emails stealing passwords or personal details
- Malicious attachments with malware or ransomware
- Fake payment requests or business information demands
- Spoofed sender addresses pretending to be someone trusted
- Links to fake websites that capture your data
- Business Email Compromise (BEC) targeting companies

Warning signs

Spot suspicious emails by these clues:

- Unexpected requests for sensitive information or urgent action
- Email addresses with subtle misspellings or odd domains
- Generic greetings like "Dear customer" instead of your name
- Poor grammar, weird formatting, or unusual language
- Links that don't match the displayed text (hover to check)
- Surprise attachments from unknown sources

How to stay safe

Protect your email with these steps:

- Always verify the sender before clicking links or replying
- Don't open attachments from unexpected emails
- Use multi-factor authentication (MFA) on your email
- Type website addresses directly into your browser
- Keep your email app and device software updated
- Use strong, unique passwords for email accounts
- Report suspicious emails to your provider or IT team

For businesses

Add these extra protections:

- Spam and phishing filters
- Email authentication (SPF, DKIM, DMARC)
- Employee security training
- Email activity monitoring

Email accounts are gateways to your other services. If hacked, attackers can reset passwords and access everything connected. Keeping email secure protects your entire digital life.